for India, with very little pretense that the Portuguese meant to act in the best interests of their hosts.

> A bare two years after Vasco da Gama's voyage a Portuguese fleet led by Pedro Alvarez Cabral arrived on the Malabar coast. Cabral delivered a letter from the king of Portugal to the Samudri (Samudra-raja or Sea-king), the Hindu ruler of the city-state of Calicut, demanding that he expel all Muslims from his kingdom as they were enemies of the 'Holy Faith'. He met with a blank refusal; then afterwards the Samudra steadfastly maintained that Calicut had always been open to everyone who wished to trade there…
>
> (Amitav Ghosh, *In an Antique Land.)*

By 1501, Portugal had obtained the right to maintain a trading depot at Calicut, having signed a friendship agreement with Zamorin. Despite promises to remain peaceful, the Portuguese traders were constantly at odds with the Muslim merchants, oftentimes engaging them in full battle at sea. Just one year after the trading depot was built, da Gama himself returned to Calicut, intent on taking the entire port city for Portugal. He and his troops caused immense damage to the city in the attempt, after which da Gama fled up the coast to find allies among other Indian leaders. Along the way, he set up Portugal's first trading station on the subcontinent at Kochi.

Quickly, the Portuguese worked their way into the southwestern part of India, building factories, trading depots, and small colonies. Several years after da Gama's first voyage to Calicut, they established Portuguese India, a state in the Portuguese Overseas Empire. The capital of that colonial state eventually became Goa, a tiny region in the southwest. Native Goans, as well as the growing community of Portuguese, fell under the political and religious subjugation of the Portuguese crown, some 8,000 kilometers (5,000 miles) away.

This connection meant that Goa was not immune to the strict Portuguese Inquisition, during which time any behavior seen as heretical against the Catholic Church was punished severely. The Inquisition was a formative feature of Catholic Europe during the Medieval period, and in Portugal, it was formally put into law in 1536 at the request of King John III. In Goa, the Inquisition began in 1560 and targeted Jews, Buddhists, Muslims, Hindus and even sub-sects of Christianity that were deemed inappropriate.